

Questions to Assist with Impairment Assessment

1. Do you have any problems taking a bath or shower?

How do you take a bath?

If answer is tub or shower, ask the following questions:

Do you need help getting in and out? Are you able to get your clothes, towels, soap yourself? Are you able to start your water? Do you have problems with balance or do you fall? What parts of your body are you able to bathe yourself?

If answer is sponge bath, ask the following questions: Are you able to get your water and supplies? What parts of your body are you able to bathe yourself?

Does bathroom environment need modifications that impact delivery of care?

Other things to consider: condition of bathroom, need for shower bench, handles for safe transfer, slip proof rugs

2. Can you dress yourself?
3. Can you shave yourself, and brush your teeth?
4. Can you shampoo your hair, comb your hair and apply lotion?
5. Can you open jars, cans, bottles? Can you fix your meals?
6. Can you feed yourself?
7. Do you have any problems getting to the bathroom and using the toilet? Do you have trouble cleaning yourself after using the toilet?
8. Can you get in and out of you bed or chair?
9. Do you have any problems keeping your balance? Is participant at risk for falls? Are you able to walk without help?
10. Do you do any strengthening exercises or range of motion exercises?
11. Can you clean your house (sweep, dust, and mop, vacuum)? Can you change your bed linens or make your bed.
12. Can you do your own laundry? Do you have a washer and dryer? Is there a Laundromat or laundry facilities close to where you live?
13. Does anyone go with you to your appointments
14. Can you do your own shopping?

Other things to consider that don't correspond to a numbered item in the Assessment:

1. Can you take your own medicine?
2. Can you use the telephone?
3. Is COPD a diagnosis? Does participant get short of breath so that rest periods have to be built into ADLS?
4. Is Chronic Pain a diagnosis? Do painful movements prolong ADLS?
5. If Dementia is a diagnosis, does dementia impact ADLS? Does participant become aggressive or refuse care? Is participant's memory impaired so that participant falsely remembers ADLS being completed? Does the participant appear to have short-term memory impairment? Does the participant have the ability to make decisions independently?
6. Is Depression a diagnosis or during the last month, has the participant often been bothered by little interest or pleasure in doing things? Has the participant felt down, depressed or hopeless?

If the answer to either question above is yes, ask the following:

In the last two weeks, most of the day, nearly every day:

- i. has the participant had problems sleeping?
- ii. has the participant lost the ability to enjoy things that once were fun?
- iii. does the participant feel that s/he have little value as a person?
- iv. has the participant had a significant change in your appetite?
- v. how many days has the participant had trouble concentrating or making decisions?